

FEA1

Field Experience for ELL

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

While watching a recorded fourth-grade lesson that runs 42 minutes, a teacher candidate writes notes. The video was filmed in the spring and has captions. Which note is an objective observation?

- A. "The captions made the lesson easy to follow."
- B. "The teacher was excellent with ELLs."
- C. "The teacher pointed to a picture of a seed and said 'seed' twice; three students repeated the word."
- D. "The students were bored during the vocabulary part."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A candidate's note reads, "The newcomer was confused by the directions." How should it be rewritten as an objective observation?

- A. "The student needs more support."
- B. "The student was very confused by the directions."
- C. "After the directions, the student looked at a partner's paper and did not begin writing for three minutes."
- D. "The directions were too hard for the newcomer."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

After teaching a small-group lesson in a room shared with the art teacher, a candidate reflects. The lesson used 12 picture cards. Which reflection best leads to a strong next lesson?

- A. "Four of six students used 'because' in their oral answers, but two answered in single words. They may need a sentence frame. Next lesson I will model 'I think ... because ...' and post it."
- B. "Four of six students used 'because' in their answers."
- C. "The lesson went well and students seemed to enjoy it."
- D. "Next time I will use more picture cards."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A candidate is planning a sixth-grade science lesson on the water cycle for a class that meets in a newly renovated lab. Her content objective is “Students will explain the stages of the water cycle.” The lab has twelve sinks. Which language objective fits best?

- A. “Students will orally describe a sequence using first, next, then, and finally.”
- B. “Students will learn the water cycle.”
- C. “Students will speak only English during the lab.”
- D. “Students will complete the water-cycle worksheet.”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A lesson’s language objective is “Students will write a comparison using ‘both’ and ‘however.’” Which content objective best pairs with it?

- A. “Students will write sentences using ‘both’ and ‘however.’”
- B. “Students will compare plant and animal cells.”
- C. “Students will enjoy learning about cells.”
- D. “Students will list the parts of a plant cell.”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A candidate teaches a class with a beginning-level newcomer, two intermediate learners, and fluent peers. The class has a reading corner with beanbags. The goal is to explain why the moon has phases. How should she differentiate the task?

- A. Everyone writes the same paragraph with no supports.
- B. The newcomer reads quietly in the beanbag corner until her English improves.
- C. The newcomer colors a picture of the moon while others learn about phases.
- D. Beginner labels a moon-phase diagram and explains with gestures and key words; intermediate learners use sentence frames; fluent peers write a paragraph.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A candidate writes a task: “Using the word bank and the frame ‘The ___ is ___ because ___,’ tell a partner which material is best for an umbrella.” Which proficiency level is this task best matched to?

- A.** Intermediate (developing) learners
- B.** Every level equally
- C.** Fully fluent learners
- D.** Brand-new beginners with no English

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A candidate gives three-step directions for a math station in a room with a noisy heater. She asks, “Does everyone understand?” and every ELL nods. The station has 15 minutes on the timer. What should she do next?

- A.** Ask again, “Are you sure you understand?”
- B.** Repeat the directions louder over the heater.
- C.** Ask a few students to show or tell a partner the first step, and watch as they start.
- D.** Start the timer, since everyone nodded.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Halfway through a lesson, a candidate sees that several ELLs sorted cards incorrectly on a “solid, liquid, gas” sort. What does this check tell her?

- A.** She should ask the class whether they understand.
- B.** The students understood, since they completed the sort.
- C.** Card sorts do not work with ELLs.
- D.** Those students need re-teaching on the concept, perhaps with realia, before moving on.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

Two Spanish-speaking students in a seventh-grade class with a large window view are learning the word “photosynthesis.” One reads well in Spanish. The class uses a new textbook series. Which strategy best uses their home language?

- A.** Give them the whole chapter translated and skip English.
- B.** Point out the cognate fotosíntesis, let partners discuss the idea in Spanish, then share in English.
- C.** Require English only so they learn faster.
- D.** Seat them apart so they do not rely on each other.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A candidate needs a text for a third-grade unit on communities for a class that includes newcomers from several countries. The school library recently got new shelving. Which resource is the best choice?

- A.** A free online worksheet with a crossword
- B.** A leveled text with photos of different kinds of communities, a picture glossary, and families from several cultures
- C.** The most popular grade-level chapter book about one town
- D.** A kindergarten picture book, since newcomers cannot read grade-level material

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

After a supervised lesson, the cooperating teacher, who has a master’s degree, notes that the candidate talked for 80% of the class time and ELLs had little chance to speak. The feedback form is two pages. What is the best response?

- A.** Thank the teacher and file the form.
- B.** Stop explaining anything so students talk 100% of the time.
- C.** Explain that the content required a lot of teacher explanation.
- D.** Plan structured partner talk with sentence frames in the next lesson and ask the teacher to tally student talk time.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

While watching a recorded fourth-grade lesson ~~that runs 42 minutes~~, a teacher candidate writes notes. ~~The video was filmed in the spring and has captions.~~ Which note is an objective observation?

Target word: objective note **Decides:** An observation records visible, audible behavior.

A	Camouflage	About the video format, not the teaching observed.
B	Adjacent category	A judgment, not a description.
C	Correct	Records actions and words without interpretation.
D	Confusion set	An inference about feelings, not an observation.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

A candidate's note reads, "The newcomer was confused by the directions." How should it be rewritten as an objective observation?

Target word: convert an inference into an observation **Decides:** Describe what was seen that led to the inference.

A	Adjacent category	A recommendation, not an observation.
B	Absolute language	Strengthens the inference instead of removing it.
C	Correct	States observable behavior the reader can interpret.
D	Inverted operation	Shifts the judgment to the directions; still an inference.

3. Answer A Concept 2

After teaching a small-group lesson ~~in a room shared with the art teacher~~, a candidate reflects. ~~The lesson used 12 picture cards.~~ Which reflection best leads to a strong next lesson?

Target word: complete reflection cycle **Decides:** Evidence → reason → specific plan.

A	Correct	Moves from evidence to cause to a specific change.
B	Adjacent category	Evidence only; stops before analysis and planning.
C	Dropped element	Drops evidence, analysis, and a plan.
D	Camouflage	A change without evidence or a reason; the card count was not the issue.

4. Answer A Concept 3

A candidate is planning a sixth-grade science lesson on the water cycle for a class ~~that meets in a newly renovated lab~~. Her content objective is "Students will explain the stages of the water cycle." ~~The lab has twelve sinks.~~ Which language objective fits best?

Target word: language objective **Decides:** It must name a language function and form tied to the content.

A	Correct	Names a language function (sequencing) and forms (transition words).
B	Confusion set	Restates the content objective with no language focus.
C	Absolute language	A behavior rule, not a language learning goal.
D	Adjacent category	An activity, not a language objective.

5. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

A lesson's language objective is "Students will write a comparison using 'both' and 'however.'" Which content objective best pairs with it?

Target word: content objective from the language objective (reverse) **Decides:** The content must require comparing.

A	Confusion set	Repeats the language objective.
B	Correct	The content task calls for the comparison language.
C	Adjacent category	Not measurable content.
D	Dropped element	Listing does not require comparison.

6. Answer D Concept 4

A candidate teaches a class with a beginning-level newcomer, two intermediate learners, and fluent peers. ~~The class has a reading corner with beanbags.~~ The goal is to explain why the moon has phases. How should she differentiate the task?

Target word: differentiate by proficiency **Decides:** Keep the content goal; vary the language demand.

A	Absolute language	Ignores proficiency differences.
B	Camouflage	Excludes her from grade-level content.
C	Dropped element	Drops the content goal for the beginner.
D	Correct	Same concept, with language demands matched to level.

7. Answer A Concept 4 • transfer

A candidate writes a task: "Using the word bank and the frame 'The ___ is ___ because ___,' tell a partner which material is best for an umbrella." Which proficiency level is this task best matched to?

Target word: identify level from the task (reverse) **Decides:** A word bank and sentence frame for oral output suit developing learners.

A	Correct	They can produce sentences with frames and a word bank.
B	Absolute language	Supports work best when matched to a level.
C	Confusion set	They would not need a frame and word bank.
D	Inverted operation	Beginners usually need picture support and one-word or gestured responses first.

8. Answer C Concept 5

A candidate gives three-step directions for a math station ~~in a room with a noisy heater.~~ She asks, "Does everyone understand?" and every ELL nods. ~~The station has 15 minutes on the timer.~~ What should she do next?

Target word: check understanding **Decides:** Nods are not evidence.

A	Adjacent category	Still a yes/no question.
B	Camouflage	Volume is not the problem; she has no evidence either way.
C	Correct	An active check produces observable evidence.
D	Confusion set	Nods often mean politeness, not understanding.

9. Answer D Concept 5 · transfer

Halfway through a lesson, a candidate sees that several ELLs sorted cards incorrectly on a “solid, liquid, gas” sort. What does this check tell her?

Target word: read the evidence from an active check (reverse) **Decides:** The sort gives observable evidence that some students have not grasped the concept.

A	Inverted operation	Replaces real evidence with a yes/no question.
B	Confusion set	Completing a task is not the same as doing it correctly.
C	Absolute language	The sort worked: it revealed the gap.
D	Correct	An active check shows who needs what, so she can adjust.

10. Answer B Concept 6

Two Spanish-speaking students in a seventh-grade class ~~with a large window view~~ are learning the word “photosynthesis.” One reads well in Spanish. ~~The class uses a new textbook series.~~ Which strategy best uses their home language?

Target word: use of the home language **Decides:** Spanish shares cognates with science terms, and one student has strong L1 literacy.

A	Inverted operation	Over-relies on translation and drops English development.
B	Correct	Uses the home language as a bridge to content and English.
C	Absolute language	Removing the home language removes a strong support.
D	Adjacent category	Removes useful peer support.

11. Answer B Concept 7

A candidate needs a text for a third-grade unit on communities for a class that includes newcomers from several countries. ~~The school library recently got new shelving.~~ Which resource is the best choice?

Target word: resource selection **Decides:** Match goal, proficiency, and culture.

A	Confusion set	Free and fun, but not aligned or supportive.
B	Correct	Matches the goal, provides visual support, and reflects learners’ backgrounds.
C	Adjacent category	Popularity does not mean it fits proficiency or background.
D	Absolute language	Lowers the content level instead of supporting access to it.

12. Answer D Concept 8

After a supervised lesson, the cooperating teacher, ~~who has a master’s degree,~~ notes that the candidate talked for 80% of the class time and ELLs had little chance to speak. ~~The feedback form is two pages.~~ What is the best response?

Target word: act on feedback **Decides:** Feedback names low student talk time.

A	Dropped element	Acknowledges feedback but drops any change.
B	Absolute language	Over-corrects; the goal is balanced, structured talk.
C	Inverted operation	Defends the lesson instead of acting on feedback.
D	Correct	Turns feedback into a specific change and gathers evidence.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	5	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	8	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	7	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Objective observation notes	Field notes record what was seen and heard, in observable terms, before any interpretation.	Writing judgments or guesses about feelings as if they were observations.	Choosing which note belongs in an observation log.
2	Reflect, then plan	Reflection moves from evidence (what happened) to analysis (why) to a specific next-step plan.	Stopping at description or at a general feeling about the lesson.	“Which reflection best leads to the next lesson?”
3	Content and language objectives	A standards-based ELL lesson pairs a content objective with a language objective that names the language function and form students will use.	Writing a language objective that is just the content objective or an activity.	Writing or judging a lesson’s objectives.
4	Differentiating by proficiency level	Keep the same content goal and vary the language demand and supports to match each learner’s English proficiency level.	Lowering the content goal for beginners, or giving every level the same task.	A class with learners at different English levels.
5	Checking for understanding	Use active, observable checks (show-me responses, sorts, quick drawings, partner explanations) rather than “Do you understand?”	Accepting nods or “yes” as evidence of understanding.	A teacher wants to know whether ELLs followed the directions or concept.
6	Leveraging the home language	Strategic use of the home language (cognates, bilingual glossaries, partner talk) supports content learning and English growth.	Banning the home language, or relying on translation for everything.	A student who shares a home language with peers or has strong home-language literacy.
7	Evaluating resources	Choose resources that match the learning goal, the learners’ proficiency, and their cultural backgrounds, with visuals and scaffolds built in.	Picking a resource because it is popular, free, or colorful.	Comparing materials for an ELL lesson.
8	Acting on supervisor feedback	In a supervised field experience, turn feedback into a specific, observable change in the next lesson and collect evidence of its effect.	Defending the lesson, or acknowledging feedback without changing practice.	A cooperating teacher or supervisor gives feedback after an observation.

Course scope (public description): Field Experience for ELL is the field experience component of the English Language Learning program. In this experience, students are required to complete a minimum of 15 hours of video observations for both elementary and secondary levels. Additionally, a supervised teaching experience that is face-to-face with English language learners (ELL) according to the minimum time requirements of the student's state is required. The purpose of this course is to assess the ability of students, including their engagement in field experience activities, ability to reflect on and then plan standards-based instruction in ELL, and their ability to locate and effectively use resources for teaching ELL to meet the needs of their individual learners.